

# Lab 3: Build an FP&A; Formula Model and Dashboard

TGS-2026065050 · Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

## Lab 3: Build an FP&A Formula Model and Dashboard

Course: Generative AI for Finance and Fintech (TGS-2026065050)

Mapping: K1 · A2

Suggested time: 150 minutes

Objective: Use native finance formulas, scenarios and charts to build an auditable management dashboard.

### Scenario

Northstar's CFO needs a monthly performance dashboard and a transparent base/downside forecast.

### Files

- `northstar-fpa-dashboard-starter.xlsx` - learner working file
- `northstar-fpa-dashboard-solution.xlsx` - completed formulas, controls and charts for review
- `evidence-checklist.md` - submission and verification checklist

### Before you begin

- Use only the supplied synthetic data.
- Do not enter live customer, payroll, account, credential or confidential data.
- If the required Microsoft feature is not enabled in your tenant, complete the workbook-based simulation and record the limitation.
- Keep facts, assumptions, AI suggestions and reviewer decisions visibly separate.

### Detailed procedure

#### Step 1: Review the source Actuals, Budget and Assumptions tables.

Record the evidence for Step 1 in the checklist before continuing.

#### Step 2: Complete SUMIFS, XLOOKUP, IFERROR, growth and margin formulas in the Analysis sheet.

Record the evidence for Step 2 in the checklist before continuing.

### **Step 3: Build base and downside forecasts from volume, price, cost and working-capital assumptions.**

Record the evidence for Step 3 in the checklist before continuing.

### **Step 4: Create KPI tiles and native charts linked to the Analysis table.**

Record the evidence for Step 4 in the checklist before continuing.

### **Step 5: Use Copilot plan mode to propose improvements; accept only changes that preserve auditability.**

Record the evidence for Step 5 in the checklist before continuing.

### **Step 6: Run the formula and control checks before exporting the executive summary.**

Record the evidence for Step 6 in the checklist before continuing.

## **Prompt quality pattern**

> Role: You are assisting a finance professional. Task: analyse only the named workbook table. Data boundary: do not use external or unstated facts. Controls: reconcile totals, identify missing evidence, and label assumptions. Output: return a concise table of finding, evidence, confidence, reviewer action and source cell or table.

## **Acceptance criteria**

- Dashboard charts remain linked to data; all formula checks pass; total variance equals actual less budget; scenarios use assumption cells rather than hard-coded outputs.
- All generated claims have been checked against the workbook or approved knowledge.
- No live credentials, personal data or confidential business data appear in the evidence.
- A human reviewer and approval status are recorded.

## **Deliverable**

An editable dashboard with actual, budget, variance, forecast and driver views.

## **Reflection**

1. What did the AI accelerate?
2. What still required finance judgement?
3. Which control prevented the most serious failure?
4. What evidence is needed before this design can scale?

